5. Click Posts in the menu on the left.
6. Click Add New.
7. Type in a title and text, and upload an image to your post.
8. Click Publish.
9. Go back to the blog by clicking on the View Post link.

Now you're ready to scale. We've prepared a load test that will send 500,000 requests to the WordPress setup within a few minutes. Don't worry about costs: the usage is covered by the Free Tier. After three minutes, new virtual machines will be launched to handle the load. The load test takes 10 minutes. Another 15 minutes later, the additional VMs will disappear. Watching this is fun; you shouldn't miss it.

NOTE If you plan to do a big load test, consider the AWS Acceptable Use Policy at https://aws.amazon.com/aup and ask for permission before you begin (see also http://mng.bz/2r8m).

Simple HTTP load test

We're using a tool called Apache Bench to perform a load test of the WordPress setup. The tool is part of the `httpd-tools` package available from the Amazon Linux package repositories.

Apache Bench is a basic benchmarking tool. You can send a specified number of HTTP requests by using a specified number of threads. We're using the following command for the load test to send 500,000 requests to the load balancer using 15 threads. The load test is limited to 600 seconds, and we're using a connection timeout of 120 seconds. Replace `$UrlLoadBalancer` with the URL of the load balancer:

```
$ ab -n 500000 -c 15 -t 300 -s 120 -r $UrlLoadBalancer
```

Update the CloudFormation stack with the following command to start the load test:

```
$ aws cloudformation update-stack --stack-name wordpress \
➥ --template-url https:/ /s3.amazonaws.com/\
➥ awsinaction-code3/chapter17/wordpress-loadtest.yaml --parameters \
➥ ParameterKey=WordpressAdminPassword,UsePreviousValue=true  \
➥ --capabilities CAPABILITY_IAM
```

Watch for the following things to happen, using the AWS Management Console:

1. Open the CloudWatch service, and click Alarms on the left.